



United States
Attorney's Office
Eastern District of Wisconsin



Florida Man Sentenced to 22 Months' Imprisonment for Conspiracy to Pay and Receive Healthcare Kickbacks

Tuesday, June 3, 2025

For Immediate Release

U.S. Attorney's Office, Eastern District of Wisconsin

Richard G. Frohling, Acting United States Attorney for the Eastern District of Wisconsin, announced that on May 29, 2025, U.S. District Judge Joseph P. Stadtmueller sentenced Michael G.V. Comino to 22 months' imprisonment for conspiracy to pay and receive healthcare kickbacks in violation of the Anti-Kickback Statute. Comino was also ordered to pay over \$2 million in restitution to Medicare.

According to court records, Comino and his co-defendant owned Kestrel Medical LLC, a company that supplied durable medical equipment, such as orthotic devices, including braces for ankles, knees, backs, and shoulders. Beginning in August 2019, Comino began providing "leads" or signed doctors' orders to Kestrel in exchange for kickback payments to two companies he owned. Comino became a fifty percent owner of Kestrel in approximately February 2020, after which he continued to offer and pay kickbacks for signed doctors' orders. Comino and his co-defendant concealed the nature of the kickback payments by paying invoices for marketing hours. As a result of the conspiracy, Medicare paid over \$2 million to Kestrel. Comino personally received hundreds of thousands of dollars from Kestrel in 2019 and 2020.

"The United States Attorney Office prioritizes efforts to stop healthcare fraud and will continue to hold accountable individuals who intentionally misuse Medicare and Medicaid dollars," said Acting U.S. Attorney Frohling. "The restitution order and prison sentence in this case underscore that providers of medical equipment and supplies cannot engage in unlawful schemes that put their interests ahead of those of the American taxpayer."

"Individuals like Mr. Comino must face the consequences of their actions that defrauded the American people and wasted taxpayer money. This case sends a clear message that healthcare kickback schemes won't be tolerated," said FBI Milwaukee Special Agent in Charge Michael Hensle. "The FBI will continue to work vigorously with our partners to combat and prevent healthcare fraud."

“The conduct in this investigation highlights a scheme whereby the defendant prioritized profits over patient care, in violation of the Anti-Kickback Statute.” said Special Agent in Charge Mario M. Pinto of the Department of Health and Human Services, Office of Inspector General (HHS-OIG). “Working together with our law enforcement partners, HHS-OIG will continue to protect the integrity of federal health care programs.”

The FBI and HHS-OIG investigated the case, which Assistant U.S. Attorney John Scully prosecuted.

###

For further information contact:

Public Information Officer

Kenneth.Gales@usdoj.gov

(414) 297-1700

[Follow us on Twitter](#)



Updated June 3, 2025

Component

[USAO - Wisconsin, Eastern](#)

Related Content

PRESS RELEASE

Manitowoc Resident Indicted on Child Obscenity and Commission of a Felony Sex Offense by a Registered Sex Offender

August 11, 2026

PRESS RELEASE

Milwaukee County Man Sentenced to 18 Months in Federal Prison for Wire Fraud Involving Government Benefit Programs

August 6, 2026

PRESS RELEASE

Illinois Man Sentenced to 15 Months in Prison for Failing to Pay Employment Taxes

August 6, 2026



Eastern District of Wisconsin

Main office

